Executive Summary Report

Global Superstore Sales and Profitability Dashboard

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1. Executive Summary

This report summarises the findings of the Global Superstore executive dashboard, built in Microsoft Power BI from 51,290 order lines covering 2011 to 2014 (25,035 unique orders). The business is growing and profitable, with sales of $12.64M and profit of $1.47M, but profit has not grown faster than sales. Three issues limit performance: Tables lose money, EMEA converts sales to profit poorly, and Furniture earns a thin margin. At the same time, Technology, APAC and EU, and the Corporate and Home Office segments offer clear room for growth. Figures are shown in dollars as recorded in the dataset.

Total Sales	Total Profit	Total Orders	Avg Sales per Order	Profit Margin
$12.64M	$1.47M	25,035	$505	11.6%

Business questions answered

Business question	Answer from the dashboard
Overall sales performance?	$12.64M sales, $1.47M profit, 25,035 orders, 11.6% margin; sales up about 90% from 2011 to 2014.
Which regions earn most sales and profit?	APAC leads both ($3.59M sales, $0.44M profit), followed by EU, US and LATAM.
Which segments contribute most revenue?	Consumer (51.5%), then Corporate (30.3%) and Home Office (18.3%).
Which categories perform best?	Technology on sales and margin; Furniture has the weakest margin (6.9%).
Which products are most profitable?	Copiers ($259K) and Phones ($217K); Tables are the only loss-maker (about -$64K).
What trends appear over time?	Strong sales growth every year, a year-end peak, and a flat margin of about 11% to 12%.

2. Five Key Business Insights

#	Insight	Evidence from the dashboard
1	The company is healthy overall: sales of about $12.64M produced $1.47M in profit at an 11.6% margin.	KPI cards. Average order value is about $505 across 25,035 orders.
2	Four markets drive the business, and APAC leads both sales and profit.	Sales by Market and Profit by Market: APAC $3.59M sales / $0.44M profit; EU $2.94M / $0.37M; US $2.30M / $0.29M; LATAM $2.16M / $0.22M. Together APAC, EU and the US give about 70% of sales.
3	Technology is the strongest category, while Furniture sells well but earns little.	Sales by Category and the matrix: Technology $4.74M sales, $664K profit, 14.0% margin. Furniture $4.11M sales but only 6.9% margin. Office Supplies earns 13.7%.

#	Insight	Evidence from the dashboard
4	Consumers bring in over half of revenue, but all three segments are equally profitable.	Sales Share by Customer Segment: Consumer 51.5%, Corporate 30.3%, Home Office 18.3%. Margins are similar at about 11.5% to 12.0%.
5	Sales have almost doubled since 2011 with a clear year-end peak, but the margin has not improved.	Monthly Sales Trend by Year: $2.26M in 2011 to $4.30M in 2014 (+90%). November and December produce about a quarter of annual sales. The margin stayed between 11.0% and 11.9%.

3. Three Business Risks

#	Risk	Evidence from the dashboard
1	Loss-making product: Tables lose money overall.	Profit by Sub-Category: Tables show a loss of about $64K on roughly $757K of sales, the only sub-category with negative profit.
2	Weak profitability in EMEA and Africa.	Sales by Market vs Profit by Market: EMEA earns only $44K profit on $0.81M sales (5.4% margin), and Africa $89K on $0.78M, compared with about 12% in APAC, EU and the US.
3	Low-margin Furniture and a high dependence on three markets.	Matrix: Furniture margin is 6.9% against 13.7% to 14.0% for the other categories. APAC, EU and the US generate about 75% of total profit, so a downturn in any of them would hit results.

4. Three Business Opportunities

#	Opportunity	Evidence from the dashboard
1	Grow Technology, especially Copiers and Phones.	Copiers ($259K) and Phones ($217K) are the two most profitable sub-categories, and Technology has the highest margin and the highest sales of any category.
2	Expand in proven markets and test Canada.	APAC and EU already lead on sales and profit with healthy margins (12.2% and 12.7%). Canada has a small base ($0.07M) but the highest margin (26.6%), so it may be under-served.
3	Win more Corporate and Home Office customers, and prepare for the year-end peak.	Corporate and Home Office together provide about 49% of sales at margins equal to or better than Consumer. The November to December peak shows when demand is highest.

5. Business Recommendations

Each recommendation below is linked to the insight, risk or opportunity that supports it.

#	Recommendation	Supporting evidence	Expected benefit
1	Reprice, renegotiate supplier costs on, or discontinue Tables.	Risk 1: about $64K loss on $757K sales.	Removes the only loss-making sub-category and lifts total profit.
2	Investigate EMEA (and Africa): review pricing, shipping costs and discounting in these markets.	Risk 2: EMEA margin 5.4% against about 12% elsewhere.	Closing half the margin gap to the other large markets would add roughly $27K in profit on current EMEA sales.

#	Recommendation	Supporting evidence	Expected benefit
3	Introduce a discount cap and approval step for discounts of 50% or more.	Supplementary data check: order lines discounted 50% or more lost about $571K on $696K sales, while undiscounted lines earned about $1.77M.	Stops deep-discount losses without hurting normal sales.
4	Prioritise Technology: increase stock, marketing and sales effort for Copiers and Phones, and stock up before November and December.	Insight 3, Opportunity 1 and Insight 5.	Grows the highest-margin, highest-sales category at the busiest time of year.
5	Invest in APAC and EU, and run a pilot to grow in Canada.	Insight 2 and Opportunity 2.	Builds on markets that already convert sales into profit and reduces reliance on weaker regions.
6	Raise Furniture margins through supplier negotiation, price adjustments and less discounting; run targeted offers for Corporate and Home Office customers.	Risk 3 and Opportunity 3.	Lifts the overall margin above 11.6% and broadens the customer base.

Note: recommendation 3 uses a supplementary check of the underlying data, because the dashboard does not yet include a discount visual. About 24% of all order lines in the dataset are loss-making, and Turkey and Nigeria are the countries with the largest overall losses. A Discount vs Profit chart can be added to the dashboard to show this directly.

6. Conclusion

Global Superstore has strong growth and healthy overall margins, and the greatest gains now come from improving profit quality rather than selling more. Fixing loss-makers (Tables, deep discounts, EMEA), and focusing effort on Technology, APAC, EU and the Corporate and Home Office segments, would raise the margin while keeping sales growing.